

D769

Secondary Literacy Methods and Interventions

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A high school wants to find ninth graders who need reading support before first-quarter grades come out. The school has a new football stadium and 420 incoming freshmen. Which plan fits universal screening?

- A. Give a full diagnostic test only to students teachers are worried about.
- B. Review prior state reading scores for all freshmen and give a brief reading screener in the first weeks.
- C. Wait for first-quarter failing grades to identify students.
- D. Screen only athletes at the stadium orientation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A tenth grader qualifies for Tier 2 reading intervention. The counselor plans to move him from English 10 into the intervention class. He plays varsity basketball and his English teacher just won an award. What is the MTSS concern?

- A. Tier 2 should add to core English instruction, not replace it; schedule it during an elective or intervention period.
- B. Schedule it during basketball practice instead.
- C. Place him directly in Tier 3.
- D. No concern; intervention is more important than English 10.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school says its Tier 2 plan is to have struggling readers skip science to attend a reading class. What is the flaw?

- A. Tier 2 should never happen during the school day.
- B. Science is less important than reading, so there is no flaw.
- C. It replaces core content instruction, so students lose grade-level learning instead of gaining extra support.
- D. Tier 2 should be whole-class, not small group.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An eighth grader has received well-delivered Tier 2 reading support in a group of five for 12 weeks with little growth. Her attendance is excellent, and she recently joined the robotics team. What is the most appropriate next step?

- A. Reduce her robotics time.
- B. Provide Tier 3: more intensive, individualized intervention in a smaller group with more time and weekly monitoring.
- C. Return her to Tier 1 only.
- D. Place her in special education without an evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A ninth grader scores low on a reading comprehension test. His science teacher says he is polite and always turns in homework. No one has checked his word reading. What should the interventionist do first?

- A. Give extra credit for homework to raise his grade.
- B. Assess word reading and language comprehension separately to find which part is weak.
- C. Assume he is unmotivated.
- D. Start a comprehension-strategy group right away.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A tenth grader reads grade-level text aloud accurately and fluently but cannot answer questions about it, even when the text is read to her. Which area should intervention target?

- A. Reading speed.
- B. Phonics and decoding.
- C. Language comprehension, such as vocabulary, background knowledge, and text structure.
- D. Handwriting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An eleventh grader reads short words well but stops at words like “photosynthesis” in biology. He is on the swim team and his biology book has a glossy cover. Which strategy should the teacher teach?

- A. Skip long words and keep reading.
- B. Guess from the first letter and the picture.
- C. Memorize the whole word from the glossary.
- D. Break the word into parts (photo-syn-the-sis), read each part, then blend and check the word.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A ninth grader reads a passage for 1.5 minutes, reading 180 words with 9 errors. The passage is about volcanoes and has two photographs. What is her WCPM?

- A. 114
- B. 120
- C. 256.5
- D. 171

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student read for 2 minutes and read 250 words. Her WCPM was 120. How many errors did she make?

- A. 5
- B. 240
- C. 130
- D. 10

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A seventh grader moves into Tier 3 reading intervention. The school gives benchmark tests in fall, winter, and spring, and the intervention teacher has a new laptop cart. How often should her progress be monitored?

- A.** Once a year
- B.** Only when grades drop
- C.** Three times a year at benchmarks
- D.** Weekly

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which student should typically be monitored least often?

- A.** A student who just exited Tier 2.
- B.** A student in Tier 2.
- C.** A student in Tier 1 who meets benchmark.
- D.** A student in Tier 3.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A tenth-grade history teacher has students reading from fourth-grade to college level. Her class meets in a room with a large world map, and the unit lasts four weeks. Which Tier 1 plan best supports all students?

- A.** Use text sets on the same topic at different levels, preview key vocabulary, and group students flexibly by task.
- B.** Give everyone the same textbook chapter with no supports.
- C.** Have students label the world map instead of reading.
- D.** Send the weakest readers to intervention during history.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A high school wants to find ninth graders who need reading support before first-quarter grades come out. ~~The school has a new football stadium and 420 incoming freshmen.~~ Which plan fits universal screening?

Target word: screening plan **Decides:** All students, brief valid measures, early in the year.

A	Adjacent category	Diagnostic testing is for a subset after screening, not universal.
B	Correct	Screening covers everyone early with brief, valid data.
C	Inverted operation	Waits for failure instead of preventing it.
D	Camouflage	The stadium detail is irrelevant; screening covers all students.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A tenth grader qualifies for Tier 2 reading intervention. The counselor plans to move him from English 10 into the intervention class. ~~He plays varsity basketball and his English teacher just won an award.~~ What is the MTSS concern?

Target word: Tier 2 scheduling **Decides:** Tier 2 is in addition to core instruction.

A	Correct	Replacing core removes grade-level instruction.
B	Camouflage	The sport detail does not decide the MTSS principle.
C	Adjacent category	Tier 3 is for students who have not responded to Tier 2.
D	Absolute language	Students need both core and supplemental instruction.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

A school says its Tier 2 plan is to have struggling readers skip science to attend a reading class. What is the flaw?

Target word: why replacing core is wrong **Decides:** Tier 2 supplements core.

A	Absolute language	Tier 2 commonly happens during a set intervention time.
B	Inverted operation	Treats replacement as acceptable.
C	Correct	Tier 2 must add to Tier 1.
D	Confusion set	Tier 2 is small group; that is not the flaw.

4. Answer B Concept 3

An eighth grader has received well-delivered Tier 2 reading support in a group of five for 12 weeks with little growth. ~~Her attendance is excellent, and she recently joined the robotics team.~~ What is the most appropriate next step?

Target word: move to Tier 3 **Decides:** Poor response to well-delivered Tier 2.

A	Camouflage	The club is irrelevant to the instructional decision.
B	Correct	Nonresponse to Tier 2 calls for intensified, individualized support.
C	Inverted operation	Removes support she still needs.
D	Adjacent category	Tier 3 is not special education; eligibility needs an evaluation.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A ninth grader scores low on a reading comprehension test. ~~His science teacher says he is polite and always turns in homework.~~ No one has checked his word reading. What should the interventionist do first?

Target word: diagnostic first step **Decides:** Low comprehension could come from decoding or language; check which.

A	Camouflage	Uses the homework detail; it does not diagnose the reading gap.
B	Correct	The Simple View shows where to target intervention.
C	Adjacent category	His homework record argues against it and it is not a skill check.
D	Dropped element	Skips checking whether decoding is the barrier.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A tenth grader reads grade-level text aloud accurately and fluently but cannot answer questions about it, even when the text is read to her. Which area should intervention target?

Target word: profile from data **Decides:** Decoding is strong; language comprehension is weak.

A	Confusion set	She already reads fluently.
B	Inverted operation	Her accurate, fluent reading shows decoding is strong.
C	Correct	Word reading is intact; understanding is the gap.
D	Adjacent category	Not a reading comprehension component.

7. Answer D Concept 5

An eleventh grader reads short words well but stops at words like “photosynthesis” in biology. ~~He is on the swim team and his biology book has a glossy cover.~~ Which strategy should the teacher teach?

Target word: multisyllabic decoding strategy **Decides:** He needs a way to break long words apart.

A	Dropped element	Skipping key content words blocks understanding.
B	Inverted operation	Guessing replaces decoding rather than building it.
C	Camouflage	One word at a time does not give a strategy for new words.
D	Correct	Chunking into syllables and morphemes lets him read long words.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A ninth grader reads a passage for 1.5 minutes, reading 180 words with 9 errors. ~~The passage is about volcanoes and has two photographs.~~ What is her WCPM?

Target word: compute WCPM **Decides:** $(180 - 9) / 1.5 = 114$.

A	Correct	$171 \text{ correct words} / 1.5 \text{ minutes} = 114$.
B	Dropped element	$180 / 1.5$ ignores errors.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies by 1.5 instead of dividing.
D	Wrong stem number	Words correct, not per minute.

9. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

A student read for 2 minutes and read 250 words. Her WCPM was 120. How many errors did she make?

Target word: solve for errors **Decides:** $120 \times 2 = 240$ correct; $250 - 240 = 10$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides the errors by time.
B	Wrong stem number	Words correct, not errors.
C	Dropped element	$250 - 120$ forgets to multiply by 2 minutes.
D	Correct	240 words correct out of 250 read.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A seventh grader moves into Tier 3 reading intervention. The school gives benchmark tests in fall, winter, and spring, ~~and the intervention teacher has a new laptop cart.~~ How often should her progress be monitored?

Target word: monitoring frequency for Tier 3 **Decides:** Tier 3 = weekly.

A	Wrong stem number	Far too infrequent.
B	Adjacent category	Grades are not a progress-monitoring measure.
C	Camouflage	Benchmarks are for all students; they are too sparse for Tier 3.
D	Correct	Intensive intervention needs frequent data to adjust quickly.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

Which student should typically be monitored least often?

Target word: reverse: lowest frequency **Decides:** Tier 1 students at benchmark.

A	Adjacent category	Recent exits are often watched more closely for a time.
B	Confusion set	Tier 2 is monitored every one to two weeks.
C	Correct	Benchmark screening (about three times a year) is enough.
D	Inverted operation	Tier 3 needs the most frequent monitoring.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A tenth-grade history teacher has students reading from fourth-grade to college level. ~~Her class meets in a room with a large world map, and the unit lasts four weeks.~~ Which Tier 1 plan best supports all students?

Target word: differentiated Tier 1 **Decides:** Flexible supports so all access grade-level content.

A	Correct	Differentiation keeps grade-level content accessible to all.
B	Absolute language	One-size instruction leaves many students out.
C	Camouflage	Uses the room detail but drops the reading.
D	Inverted operation	Removes them from core content.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Universal screening in secondary MTSS	All students are screened with brief, valid measures (often plus existing data such as state test scores) to find who may need reading support.	Waiting for students to fail classes before identifying reading needs.	A school wants to know which incoming ninth graders need reading support.
2	Tier 2 is supplemental	Tier 2 adds targeted small-group instruction to core Tier 1 content instruction; it does not replace it.	Pulling students out of core English or science to attend intervention.	A schedule change for students entering Tier 2.
3	Tier 3 is intensive and individualized	Tier 3 provides the most intensive, individualized intervention with very small groups, more time, and frequent monitoring for students who did not respond to Tier 2.	Equating Tier 3 with special education placement.	A student has not responded to well-delivered Tier 2.
4	Profiling adolescent readers with the Simple View	Reading comprehension = decoding × language comprehension; a diagnostic check separates students who cannot read the words from those who read words but do not understand.	Giving every struggling adolescent the same comprehension-strategy intervention.	A student with low comprehension scores and no data on word reading.
5	Multisyllabic word reading	Teach adolescents to break long words into syllables and meaningful parts (prefix, root, suffix), read each part, then blend and check the word.	Telling students to skip long words or guess from context.	A student reads short words well but stalls on long academic words.
6	Words correct per minute	WCPM = (words read – errors) / minutes read.	Forgetting to subtract errors or to divide by time.	A number of words read, errors, and a time other than one minute.
7	Progress-monitoring frequency	Monitor more often as intensity rises: typically every one to two weeks in Tier 2 and weekly in Tier 3.	Monitoring Tier 3 students only at benchmark times (three times a year).	A question about how often to check a Tier 2 or Tier 3 student.
8	Differentiated Tier 1 in content classes	Core content teachers use flexible grouping and varied supports (text sets at different levels, guided notes, vocabulary previews) so all students access grade-level content.	Assuming Tier 1 is one-size-fits-all and all differentiation happens in intervention.	A content teacher with a wide range of readers in one class.

Course scope (public description): Secondary Literacy Methods & Interventions utilizes MTSS to equip educators with evidence-based strategies to address adolescents' reading challenges through the Multi-Tiered System of Supports Model. Candidates learn to identify, monitor, and provide differentiated instruction, integrating screening tools and progress monitoring to enhance comprehension. The course emphasizes the development of personalized intervention plans while utilizing reading assessments for informed instructional decisions. By completion, candidates compile intervention strategies supporting learners across MTSS tiers, fostering inclusive

environments for academic success.